

Canonical murder facts

Grant Larceny dies from a botanical cardiac toxin applied inside his private silver coupe and on its rim using toxin-dampened gold-seamed linen. It was introduced in the Donor Salon, 6:40–6:49. One of the attending 15 core roles is selected through the blind animal draw. Optional roles cannot be selected.

All essential facts are heard in the three mandatory hearings. Three overlapping suspect groups emerge: guests who entered the salon during the poisoning window, guests who borrowed the cabinet key during setup, and guests who carried the matching linen. Only the murderer belongs to all three. No record names a person seen committing the crime. The lone culprit did not exchange keys, badges, samples or linen with another guest.

The actual murder narrative and confession are never printed in the four active-play pages. The separate named FINALE envelope opens only after ballots are collected. All fixed clues work for every eligible murderer.

Warning notes and flickering lights are human-made; no curse causes the death.

01 / Artie Ficial

Victim relationship: Grant had privately informed you that tonight's gift would come with a new governance agreement: he wanted veto power over acquisitions, his name on the museum, and your resignation within sixty days. You smiled through the meeting and told no one.

Hidden complication: You have already accepted a confidential offer to lead a rival museum next year, which makes any argument with Grant look like succession planning.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, correcting Grant's speech cards. I did not go back after that. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the podium polish stored inside. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for rescuing a champagne-spotted gala program. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: During setup you borrowed the controlled cabinet key and took the toxin sample. At 6:47 you entered the Donor Salon, correcting Grant's speech cards. You dampened your issued gold-seamed linen with the stolen sample and wiped the inside of Grant's coupe and its rim, transferring the toxin. You left with the cloth. You acted alone.

Innocent evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: loan at 6:00, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: correcting Grant's speech cards; rescuing a champagne-spotted gala program. These are the original preparation records for Artie Ficial.

Murderer evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:47. Conservation key book: loan at 6:00, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: correcting Grant's speech cards; rescuing a champagne-spotted gala program. These are the original preparation records for Artie Ficial.

02 / Claire O'Scuro

Victim relationship: You discovered that Grant knew the Star Bowl's provenance file contained a major gap and ordered the exhibition to proceed anyway. He threatened to remove you from the show if you raised the issue publicly.

Hidden complication: Against board instructions, you commissioned an independent provenance review and hid the preliminary report in the Registrar's Office.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:44, correcting the Star Bowl label. I visited the conservation display, checking the display cleaning instructions, but did not borrow the cabinet key. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for dusting the edge of a display mount. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: During setup you borrowed the controlled cabinet key and took the toxin sample. At 6:44 you entered the Donor Salon, correcting the Star Bowl label. You dampened your issued gold-seamed linen with the stolen sample and wiped the inside of Grant's coupe and its rim, transferring the toxin. You left with the cloth. You acted alone.

Innocent evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:44. Conservation key book: no key loan. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: correcting the Star Bowl label; dusting the edge of a display mount. These are the original preparation records for Claire O'Scuro.

Murderer evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:44. Conservation key book: loan at 6:01, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: correcting the Star Bowl label; dusting the edge of a display mount. These are the original preparation records for Claire O'Scuro.

03 / Hugh Bidder

Victim relationship: Grant had learned that one certificate in a major private sale you brokered was forged before it ever reached you. He planned to imply publicly that you had created it unless you refunded him millions.

Hidden complication: You were duped on that sale, but you quietly altered your own file afterward so clients would not see how badly your due diligence failed.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:46, delivering a revised appraisal. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the replica-decanter treatment sheet stored inside. I carried blue disposable paper wipes, for polishing a replica decanter for photographs. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: During setup you borrowed the controlled cabinet key and took the toxin sample. At 6:46 you entered the Donor Salon, delivering a revised appraisal. You dampened your issued gold-seamed linen with the

stolen sample and wiped the inside of Grant's coupe and its rim, transferring the toxin. You left with the cloth. You acted alone.

Innocent evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:46. Conservation key book: loan at 6:02, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: blue disposable paper wipes. Purpose noted by guest: delivering a revised appraisal; polishing a replica decanter for photographs. These are the original preparation records for Hugh Bidder.

Murderer evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:46. Conservation key book: loan at 6:02, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: delivering a revised appraisal; polishing a replica decanter for photographs. These are the original preparation records for Hugh Bidder.

04 / Monet Bags

Victim relationship: Grant demanded that you disguise several gala and naming-wing expenses inside restricted museum funds until his promised donation cleared. When you resisted, he threatened to blame the bookkeeping on you.

Hidden complication: You temporarily moved money between internal accounts to cover a cash-flow shortfall, intending to reverse it after the gala. It was technically unauthorized and Grant discovered it.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, getting his approval on an expense sheet. I did not go back after that. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the insured-stock list stored inside. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for drying a splash on my expense folder. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: During setup you borrowed the controlled cabinet key and took the toxin sample. At 6:45 you entered the Donor Salon, getting his approval on an expense sheet. You dampened your issued gold-seamed

linen with the stolen sample and wiped the inside of Grant's coupe and its rim, transferring the toxin. You left with the cloth. You acted alone.

Innocent evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: loan at 6:03, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: getting his approval on an expense sheet; drying a splash on my expense folder. These are the original preparation records for Monet Bags.

Murderer evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:45. Conservation key book: loan at 6:03, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: getting his approval on an expense sheet; drying a splash on my expense folder. These are the original preparation records for Monet Bags.

05 / Chip Patina

Victim relationship: Grant pressured you to soften a conservation report showing that one supposedly untouched object had been recently altered. He threatened to replace you with a private conservator if you refused.

Hidden complication: You changed the date on a minor treatment record last month to spare the museum an embarrassing insurance dispute. No object was harmed, but the falsification could end your career.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:43, explaining the condition report. I visited the conservation display, checking the conservation stock, but did not borrow the cabinet key. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for cleaning a display tool after setup. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: During setup you borrowed the controlled cabinet key and took the toxin sample. At 6:43 you entered the Donor Salon, explaining the condition report. You dampened your issued gold-seamed linen with the stolen sample and wiped the inside of Grant's coupe and its rim, transferring the toxin. You left with the cloth. You acted alone.

Innocent evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:43. Conservation key book: no key loan. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: explaining the condition report; cleaning a display tool after setup. These are the original preparation records for Chip Patina.

Murderer evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:43. Conservation key book: loan at 6:04, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: explaining the condition report; cleaning a display tool after setup. These are the original preparation records for Chip Patina.

06 / Dada DiCapo

Victim relationship: Grant appropriated the concept for one of your unreleased performances and planned to unveil a sanitized version of it as the gala's closing spectacle, crediting himself as creative patron.

Hidden complication: You wrote and planted the ominous anonymous warning note about 'returning what was taken.' It was meant as an art-world provocation, not a literal threat.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:42, showing him the performance sketch. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the removable stage adhesive stored inside. I carried blue disposable paper wipes, for wiping a rehearsal prop. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: During setup you borrowed the controlled cabinet key and took the toxin sample. At 6:42 you entered the Donor Salon, showing him the performance sketch. You dampened your issued gold-seamed linen with the stolen sample and wiped the inside of Grant's coupe and its rim, transferring the toxin. You left with the cloth. You acted alone.

Innocent evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:42. Conservation key book: loan at 6:05, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: blue disposable paper wipes. Purpose

noted by guest: showing him the performance sketch; wiping a rehearsal prop. These are the original preparation records for Dada DiCapo.

Murderer evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:42. Conservation key book: loan at 6:05, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: showing him the performance sketch; wiping a rehearsal prop. These are the original preparation records for Dada DiCapo.

07 / Vincent Van Faux

Victim relationship: Grant owned an embarrassing student painting you have spent years trying to buy back. He planned to display it tonight beside your celebrated recent work as a joke about 'humble beginnings.'

Hidden complication: You have secretly used buyers to acquire several of your own early paintings so you could remove them from circulation. The art world would find that both vain and market-manipulative.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, asking him to withdraw the student painting. I did not go back after that. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the varnish sample stored inside. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for cleaning a smear from my painting easel. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: During setup you borrowed the controlled cabinet key and took the toxin sample. At 6:44 you entered the Donor Salon, asking him to withdraw the student painting. You dampened your issued gold-seamed linen with the stolen sample and wiped the inside of Grant's coupe and its rim, transferring the toxin. You left with the cloth. You acted alone.

Innocent evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: loan at 6:06, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: asking him to withdraw the student painting; cleaning a smear from my painting easel. These are the original preparation records for Vincent Van Faux.

Murderer evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:44. Conservation key book: loan at 6:06, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: asking him to withdraw the student painting; cleaning a smear from my painting easel. These are the original preparation records for Vincent Van Faux.

08 / Sue Venir

Victim relationship: You wrote a private legal memorandum concluding that the Star Bowl's acquisition was too risky to defend confidently. Grant forced you to replace it with a softer opinion and planned to cite your name during the announcement.

Hidden complication: Both versions of the memo still exist. You kept the original instead of destroying it, which could expose you to professional embarrassment and Grant to serious scrutiny.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:46, delivering the donor agreement. I visited the conservation display, reading the hazardous-materials notice, but did not borrow the cabinet key. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for drying a splash on the agreement folder. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: During setup you borrowed the controlled cabinet key and took the toxin sample. At 6:46 you entered the Donor Salon, delivering the donor agreement. You dampened your issued gold-seamed linen with the stolen sample and wiped the inside of Grant's coupe and its rim, transferring the toxin. You left with the cloth. You acted alone.

Innocent evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:46. Conservation key book: no key loan. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: delivering the donor agreement; drying a splash on the agreement folder. These are the original preparation records for Sue Venir.

Murderer evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:46. Conservation key book: loan at 6:07, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: delivering the donor agreement; drying a splash on the agreement folder. These are the original preparation records for Sue Venir.

09 / Dr. Art E. Fact

Victim relationship: Grant suppressed your research showing that two objects in his collection passed through a dealer linked to questionable wartime sales. He threatened to release correspondence suggesting you had overstated another provenance claim if you challenged him publicly.

Hidden complication: One celebrated article of yours does contain an inference you stated too confidently. The main thesis still stands, but the mistake would be humiliating.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:45, showing him the disputed accession page. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the reference specimen stored inside. I carried blue disposable paper wipes, for dusting an archival display stand. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: During setup you borrowed the controlled cabinet key and took the toxin sample. At 6:45 you entered the Donor Salon, showing him the disputed accession page. You dampened your issued gold-seamed linen with the stolen sample and wiped the inside of Grant's coupe and its rim, transferring the toxin. You left with the cloth. You acted alone.

Innocent evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:45. Conservation key book: loan at 6:08, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: blue disposable paper wipes. Purpose noted by guest: showing him the disputed accession page; dusting an archival display stand. These are the original preparation records for Dr. Art E. Fact.

Murderer evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:45. Conservation key book: loan at 6:08, returned and cabinet

relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: showing him the disputed accession page; dusting an archival display stand. These are the original preparation records for Dr. Art E. Fact.

10 / Tess Tament

Victim relationship: Grant told you he intended to rewrite the family trust tonight, removing you from control of the charitable foundation unless you publicly backed his museum naming plan.

Hidden complication: You have been quietly organizing other family trustees to block Grant's control over the foundation and redirect future giving toward worker and community programs.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, discussing the family trust. I did not go back after that. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the foundation's donated treatment samples stored inside. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for wiping cordial off the edge of my folder. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: During setup you borrowed the controlled cabinet key and took the toxin sample. At 6:43 you entered the Donor Salon, discussing the family trust. You dampened your issued gold-seamed linen with the stolen sample and wiped the inside of Grant's coupe and its rim, transferring the toxin. You left with the cloth. You acted alone.

Innocent evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: loan at 6:09, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: discussing the family trust; wiping cordial off the edge of my folder. These are the original preparation records for Tess Tament.

Murderer evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:43. Conservation key book: loan at 6:09, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose

noted by guest: discussing the family trust; wiping cordial off the edge of my folder. These are the original preparation records for Tess Tament.

11 / Barb Dwyer

Victim relationship: Grant ordered you to disable the Donor Salon camera because he planned several off-the-record meetings. He then told you that if anything went wrong tonight, security would 'own the failure.'

Hidden complication: You personally unplugged the camera despite museum policy. You did it under direct donor pressure and never documented the order.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:41, checking the camera work order. I visited the conservation display, testing the cabinet lock, but did not borrow the cabinet key. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for cleaning fingerprints off a security torch. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: During setup you borrowed the controlled cabinet key and took the toxin sample. At 6:41 you entered the Donor Salon, checking the camera work order. You dampened your issued gold-seamed linen with the stolen sample and wiped the inside of Grant's coupe and its rim, transferring the toxin. You left with the cloth. You acted alone.

Innocent evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:41. Conservation key book: no key loan. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: checking the camera work order; cleaning fingerprints off a security torch. These are the original preparation records for Barb Dwyer.

Murderer evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:41. Conservation key book: loan at 6:10, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: checking the camera work order; cleaning fingerprints off a security torch. These are the original preparation records for Barb Dwyer.

12 / Paige Turner

Victim relationship: You were preparing a major investigation into Grant's collection and labor empire. He discovered enough to threaten an injunction and promised to reveal the identity of one of your confidential museum sources if you published.

Hidden complication: You obtained internal documents through a source inside the Meridian. Protecting that source matters more to you than tonight's scoop.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:45, asking about my embargoed story. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the chemical warning file stored inside. I carried blue disposable paper wipes, for drying a spill on my notebook cover. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: During setup you borrowed the controlled cabinet key and took the toxin sample. At 6:45 you entered the Donor Salon, asking about my embargoed story. You dampened your issued gold-seamed linen with the stolen sample and wiped the inside of Grant's coupe and its rim, transferring the toxin. You left with the cloth. You acted alone.

Innocent evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:45. Conservation key book: loan at 6:11, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: blue disposable paper wipes. Purpose noted by guest: asking about my embargoed story; drying a spill on my notebook cover. These are the original preparation records for Paige Turner.

Murderer evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:45. Conservation key book: loan at 6:11, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: asking about my embargoed story; drying a spill on my notebook cover. These are the original preparation records for Paige Turner.

13 / Frank Lloyd Wrong

Victim relationship: Grant demanded a dangerous last-minute change to the centerpiece display and threatened to withhold your firm's final payment if you refused. He also planned to blame you publicly for any flaw in the opening-night presentation.

Hidden complication: You signed off on one temporary lighting rig that did not fully meet your own design standard because there was no time to rebuild it before the gala.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, checking the revised display plan. I did not go back after that. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the display fasteners stored inside. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for wiping dust from a display bracket. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: During setup you borrowed the controlled cabinet key and took the toxin sample. At 6:46 you entered the Donor Salon, checking the revised display plan. You dampened your issued gold-seamed linen with the stolen sample and wiped the inside of Grant's coupe and its rim, transferring the toxin. You left with the cloth. You acted alone.

Innocent evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: loan at 6:12, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: checking the revised display plan; wiping dust from a display bracket. These are the original preparation records for Frank Lloyd Wrong.

Murderer evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:46. Conservation key book: loan at 6:12, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: checking the revised display plan; wiping dust from a display bracket. These are the original preparation records for Frank Lloyd Wrong.

14 / Mona Lott

Victim relationship: Grant intended to announce that the Star Bowl would become a permanent Meridian holding, undermining months of quiet restitution negotiations and publicly humiliating the international partners you represent.

Hidden complication: You leaked the existence of the restitution talks to selected journalists to pressure Grant, even though the negotiations were supposed to remain confidential.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:44, delivering the restitution memorandum. I visited the conservation display, reading the object-treatment label, but did not borrow the cabinet key. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for dusting the travel case for a loan object. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: During setup you borrowed the controlled cabinet key and took the toxin sample. At 6:44 you entered the Donor Salon, delivering the restitution memorandum. You dampened your issued gold-seamed linen with the stolen sample and wiped the inside of Grant's coupe and its rim, transferring the toxin. You left with the cloth. You acted alone.

Innocent evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:44. Conservation key book: no key loan. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: delivering the restitution memorandum; dusting the travel case for a loan object. These are the original preparation records for Mona Lott.

Murderer evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:44. Conservation key book: loan at 6:13, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: delivering the restitution memorandum; dusting the travel case for a loan object. These are the original preparation records for Mona Lott.

15 / Elon Mosaic

Victim relationship: Grant had blacklisted you from a major acquisition after you outbid him anonymously for a work he wanted. Tonight he planned to announce that your collecting practices were 'speculative theater' and block your appointment to the museum board.

Hidden complication: You were the anonymous buyer in the auction incident everyone keeps referencing. You concealed your identity through Hugh to avoid a bidding war with Grant.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:48, discussing the board appointment. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the reference mineral stored inside. I carried blue disposable paper wipes, for polishing my presentation case. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: During setup you borrowed the controlled cabinet key and took the toxin sample. At 6:48 you entered the Donor Salon, discussing the board appointment. You dampened your issued gold-seamed linen with the stolen sample and wiped the inside of Grant's coupe and its rim, transferring the toxin. You left with the cloth. You acted alone.

Innocent evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:48. Conservation key book: loan at 6:14, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: blue disposable paper wipes. Purpose noted by guest: discussing the board appointment; polishing my presentation case. These are the original preparation records for Elon Mosaic.

Murderer evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:48. Conservation key book: loan at 6:14, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: discussing the board appointment; polishing my presentation case. These are the original preparation records for Elon Mosaic.

16 / Anya Tique

Victim relationship: Grant planned to reveal that you accepted his first questionable donation in 1989 despite incomplete paperwork, staining the legacy you built.

Hidden complication: You did approve that accession because the museum was desperate for funds and you convinced yourself the paperwork would follow.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, asking about the old donation file. I did not go back after that. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the accession-display treatment card stored inside. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for dusting an old catalogue cover. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: This optional character is innocent in the standard draw. I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, asking about the old donation file. I did not go back after that. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the accession-display treatment card stored inside. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for dusting an old catalogue cover. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Innocent evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: loan at 6:15, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: asking about the old donation file; dusting an old catalogue cover. These are the original preparation records for Anya Tique.

Murderer evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: loan at 6:15, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: asking about the old donation file; dusting an old catalogue cover. These are the original preparation records for Anya Tique.

17 / Saul D. Bid

Victim relationship: Grant threatened to expose a private sale you arranged outside your auction house's normal process unless you waived a substantial fee.

Hidden complication: You did route the sale through a discreet subsidiary to satisfy a client who insisted on anonymity.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:45, discussing the auction fee. I visited the conservation display, checking a sale display sample, but did not borrow the cabinet key. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for polishing a catalogue stand. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: This optional character is innocent in the standard draw. I went into the Donor Salon at 6:45, discussing the auction fee. I visited the conservation display, checking a sale display sample, but did not borrow the cabinet key. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for polishing a catalogue stand. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Innocent evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:45. Conservation key book: no key loan. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: discussing the auction fee; polishing a catalogue stand. These are the original preparation records for Saul D. Bid.

Murderer evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:45. Conservation key book: no key loan. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: discussing the auction fee; polishing a catalogue stand. These are the original preparation records for Saul D. Bid.

18 / Elle Loominate

Victim relationship: Grant intended to purchase a family-owned ceremonial textile you had borrowed for your installation, despite your refusal to sell.

Hidden complication: The textile is in the exhibition without the full paperwork your family expected because you were afraid the loan would be denied.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:45, explaining the textile loan. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the fabric-treatment sample stored inside. I carried blue disposable paper wipes, for cleaning the textile display rail. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: This optional character is innocent in the standard draw. I went into the Donor Salon at 6:45, explaining the textile loan. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the fabric-treatment sample stored inside. I carried blue disposable paper wipes, for cleaning the textile display rail. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Innocent evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:45. Conservation key book: loan at 6:17, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: blue disposable paper wipes. Purpose noted by guest: explaining the textile loan; cleaning the textile display rail. These are the original preparation records for Elle Loominate.

Murderer evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:45. Conservation key book: loan at 6:17, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: blue disposable paper wipes. Purpose noted by guest: explaining the textile loan; cleaning the textile display rail. These are the original preparation records for Elle Loominate.

19 / Reed DeLabel

Victim relationship: You found an archival document that contradicted the Star Bowl label. Grant told your department your fellowship could disappear if you pushed it.

Hidden complication: You have not yet told Art that your discovery also undermines one sentence in his published research.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, showing him the archival correction. I did not go back after that. I visited the conservation

display, reading a conservation label, but did not borrow the cabinet key. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for dusting a label holder. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: This optional character is innocent in the standard draw. I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, showing him the archival correction. I did not go back after that. I visited the conservation display, reading a conservation label, but did not borrow the cabinet key. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for dusting a label holder. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Innocent evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: no key loan. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: showing him the archival correction; dusting a label holder. These are the original preparation records for Reed DeLabel.

Murderer evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: no key loan. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: showing him the archival correction; dusting a label holder. These are the original preparation records for Reed DeLabel.

20 / Al Baster

Victim relationship: Grant planned to replace your commissioned entrance sculpture with a cheaper replica after the opening and dispute your final payment.

Hidden complication: You built one internal support differently from the approved plan because the fabricator missed a deadline.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, discussing the entrance sculpture. I did not go back after that. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the resin sample stored inside. I carried blue disposable paper wipes, for wiping a sculpture support. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: This optional character is innocent in the standard draw. I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, discussing the entrance sculpture. I did not go back after that. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the resin sample stored inside. I carried blue disposable paper wipes, for wiping a sculpture support. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Innocent evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: loan at 6:19, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: blue disposable paper wipes. Purpose noted by guest: discussing the entrance sculpture; wiping a sculpture support. These are the original preparation records for Al Baster.

Murderer evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: loan at 6:19, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: blue disposable paper wipes. Purpose noted by guest: discussing the entrance sculpture; wiping a sculpture support. These are the original preparation records for Al Baster.

21 / Ella Gance

Victim relationship: Grant knew you quietly sold a work you had publicly promised to donate to another institution and planned to expose the contradiction.

Hidden complication: You sold it to cover a failed business investment and hoped to replace it before anyone noticed.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, discussing the promised donation. I did not go back after that. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the display-finish sample stored inside. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for drying a splash from my auction catalogue. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: This optional character is innocent in the standard draw. I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, discussing the promised donation. I did not go back after that. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the display-finish sample stored inside. I carried a white linen cloth with a

gold seam, for drying a splash from my auction catalogue. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Innocent evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: loan at 6:20, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: discussing the promised donation; drying a splash from my auction catalogue. These are the original preparation records for Ella Gance.

Murderer evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: loan at 6:20, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: discussing the promised donation; drying a splash from my auction catalogue. These are the original preparation records for Ella Gance.

22 / Drew Conclusions

Victim relationship: Grant discovered that you write an anonymous satirical newsletter skewering museum patrons and planned to unmask you during his speech.

Hidden complication: Several jokes in the newsletter came from private conversations, and you regret at least one of them.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:45, asking about his speech. I visited the conservation display, checking a display for my newsletter, but did not borrow the cabinet key. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for cleaning a smudge from my recording case. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: This optional character is innocent in the standard draw. I went into the Donor Salon at 6:45, asking about his speech. I visited the conservation display, checking a display for my newsletter, but did not borrow the cabinet key. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for cleaning a smudge from my recording case. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Innocent evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:45. Conservation key book: no key loan. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: asking about his speech; cleaning a smudge from my recording case. These are the original preparation records for Drew Conclusions.

Murderer evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:45. Conservation key book: no key loan. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: asking about his speech; cleaning a smudge from my recording case. These are the original preparation records for Drew Conclusions.

23 / Brie DeVivre

Victim relationship: Grant had refused to approve the final catering invoice and planned to blame you for a last-minute service change he personally ordered.

Hidden complication: You changed his private beverage setup twice because Grant and his assistant gave contradictory instructions.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:45, confirming the private menu. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the tray-cleaning notice stored inside. I carried blue disposable paper wipes, for drying a serving tray. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: This optional character is innocent in the standard draw. I went into the Donor Salon at 6:45, confirming the private menu. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the tray-cleaning notice stored inside. I carried blue disposable paper wipes, for drying a serving tray. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Innocent evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:45. Conservation key book: loan at 6:22, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: blue disposable paper wipes. Purpose noted by guest: confirming the private menu; drying a serving tray. These are the original preparation records for Brie DeVivre.

Murderer evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:45. Conservation key book: loan at 6:22, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: blue disposable paper wipes. Purpose noted by guest: confirming the private menu; drying a serving tray. These are the original preparation records for Brie DeVivre.

24 / Cary Crates

Victim relationship: Grant saw you damage a minor frame during installation and threatened to have you fired after the gala, despite the damage being repairable.

Hidden complication: You concealed the crack with a reversible mount until Chip could inspect it after opening night.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, explaining the damaged frame. I did not go back after that. I visited the conservation display, checking a frame-treatment sample, but did not borrow the cabinet key. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for cleaning a crate handle. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: This optional character is innocent in the standard draw. I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, explaining the damaged frame. I did not go back after that. I visited the conservation display, checking a frame-treatment sample, but did not borrow the cabinet key. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for cleaning a crate handle. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Innocent evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: no key loan. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: explaining the damaged frame; cleaning a crate handle. These are the original preparation records for Cary Crates.

Murderer evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: no key loan. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest:

explaining the damaged frame; cleaning a crate handle. These are the original preparation records for Cary Crates.

25 / Anne E. Dote

Victim relationship: Grant's gift conditions would cut public education programming to fund a private donor lounge and VIP entrance.

Hidden complication: You organized an anonymous staff petition against the plan and slipped copies into trustee folders.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, discussing the education budget. I did not go back after that. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the school-tour safety sheet stored inside. I carried blue disposable paper wipes, for dusting a school-tour display. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: This optional character is innocent in the standard draw. I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, discussing the education budget. I did not go back after that. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the school-tour safety sheet stored inside. I carried blue disposable paper wipes, for dusting a school-tour display. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Innocent evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: loan at 6:24, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: blue disposable paper wipes. Purpose noted by guest: discussing the education budget; dusting a school-tour display. These are the original preparation records for Anne E. Dote.

Murderer evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: loan at 6:24, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: blue disposable paper wipes. Purpose noted by guest: discussing the education budget; dusting a school-tour display. These are the original preparation records for Anne E. Dote.

26 / Faye Stop

Victim relationship: Grant ordered you to surrender a photograph showing him meeting privately with Hugh beside a shell-company shipping file.

Hidden complication: You kept a backup print after agreeing to delete the image from your camera.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, asking him about my photograph. I did not go back after that. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the display-cleaning sample stored inside. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for cleaning the outside of my camera case. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: This optional character is innocent in the standard draw. I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, asking him about my photograph. I did not go back after that. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the display-cleaning sample stored inside. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for cleaning the outside of my camera case. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Innocent evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: loan at 6:25, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: asking him about my photograph; cleaning the outside of my camera case. These are the original preparation records for Faye Stop.

Murderer evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: loan at 6:25, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: asking him about my photograph; cleaning the outside of my camera case. These are the original preparation records for Faye Stop.

27 / Robin Banks

Victim relationship: Grant had you removed from a previous museum event and threatened legal action if you disrupted tonight's unveiling.

Hidden complication: You planted small 'PROVENANCE IS A VERB' stickers in several gallery brochures for a peaceful protest.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:45, delivering my protest letter. I visited the conservation display, reading the environmental warning, but did not borrow the cabinet key. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for wiping paste from a protest placard. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: This optional character is innocent in the standard draw. I went into the Donor Salon at 6:45, delivering my protest letter. I visited the conservation display, reading the environmental warning, but did not borrow the cabinet key. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for wiping paste from a protest placard. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Innocent evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:45. Conservation key book: no key loan. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: delivering my protest letter; wiping paste from a protest placard. These are the original preparation records for Robin Banks.

Murderer evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:45. Conservation key book: no key loan. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: delivering my protest letter; wiping paste from a protest placard. These are the original preparation records for Robin Banks.

28 / Penny Pincher

Victim relationship: One decorative object in the exhibition once belonged to your family. You believe Grant acquired it through a manipulative private sale decades ago.

Hidden complication: You brought old correspondence proving your family contested that sale and planned to confront him tonight.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:45, asking about the family object. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the object-treatment label stored inside. I carried blue disposable paper wipes, for dusting the family-object display. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: This optional character is innocent in the standard draw. I went into the Donor Salon at 6:45, asking about the family object. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the object-treatment label stored inside. I carried blue disposable paper wipes, for dusting the family-object display. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Innocent evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:45. Conservation key book: loan at 6:27, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: blue disposable paper wipes. Purpose noted by guest: asking about the family object; dusting the family-object display. These are the original preparation records for Penny Pincher.

Murderer evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:45. Conservation key book: loan at 6:27, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: blue disposable paper wipes. Purpose noted by guest: asking about the family object; dusting the family-object display. These are the original preparation records for Penny Pincher.

29 / Justin Tyme

Victim relationship: Grant fed you several flattering claims for an earlier profile that you later discovered were exaggerated. He threatened to cut off access if you corrected them.

Hidden complication: You are preparing a correction that will also make you look embarrassingly credulous.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, asking about the disputed profile. I did not go back after that. I visited the conservation

display, checking an accession display, but did not borrow the cabinet key. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for cleaning a notebook cover. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: This optional character is innocent in the standard draw. I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, asking about the disputed profile. I did not go back after that. I visited the conservation display, checking an accession display, but did not borrow the cabinet key. I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for cleaning a notebook cover. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Innocent evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: no key loan. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: asking about the disputed profile; cleaning a notebook cover. These are the original preparation records for Justin Tyme.

Murderer evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: no key loan. Materials inventory, 6:39: white linen cloth, gold seam. Purpose noted by guest: asking about the disputed profile; cleaning a notebook cover. These are the original preparation records for Justin Tyme.

30 / Minnie Malist

Victim relationship: Grant ordered you to add a gaudy lighting cue to the unveiling and threatened to withhold payment when Frank objected.

Hidden complication: You secretly changed the cue again after approval, causing the eerie light flickers guests noticed during Act I.

Innocent route: I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, checking his new lighting cue. I did not go back after that. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the display cable fitting stored inside. I carried blue disposable paper wipes, for wiping a lighting controller. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Murderer route: This optional character is innocent in the standard draw. I went into the Donor Salon at 6:36, checking his new lighting cue. I did not go

back after that. I borrowed the cabinet key during setup to inspect the display cable fitting stored inside. I carried blue disposable paper wipes, for wiping a lighting controller. That was what the materials desk issued me. You did not poison Grant.

Innocent evidence / Card A: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: loan at 6:29, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: blue disposable paper wipes. Purpose noted by guest: checking his new lighting cue; wiping a lighting controller. These are the original preparation records for Minnie Malist.

Murderer evidence / Card B: MERIDIAN / SETUP RECEIPT Salon door register: 6:36; no later entry. Conservation key book: loan at 6:29, returned and cabinet relocked. Materials inventory, 6:39: blue disposable paper wipes. Purpose noted by guest: checking his new lighting cue; wiping a lighting controller. These are the original preparation records for Minnie Malist.

Difficulty & continuity

Motive reveals grievances. Opportunity establishes salon visits and setup errands. Method reveals the significance of the key and linen, then compares the original receipts. Each individual clue matches many innocent guests. Only the murderer matches the combined salon-entry, cabinet-key and gold-seamed-linen records. No essential evidence may be withheld. Optional guests do not certify another guest's movements. Scavenger discoveries add atmosphere but cannot block solving.